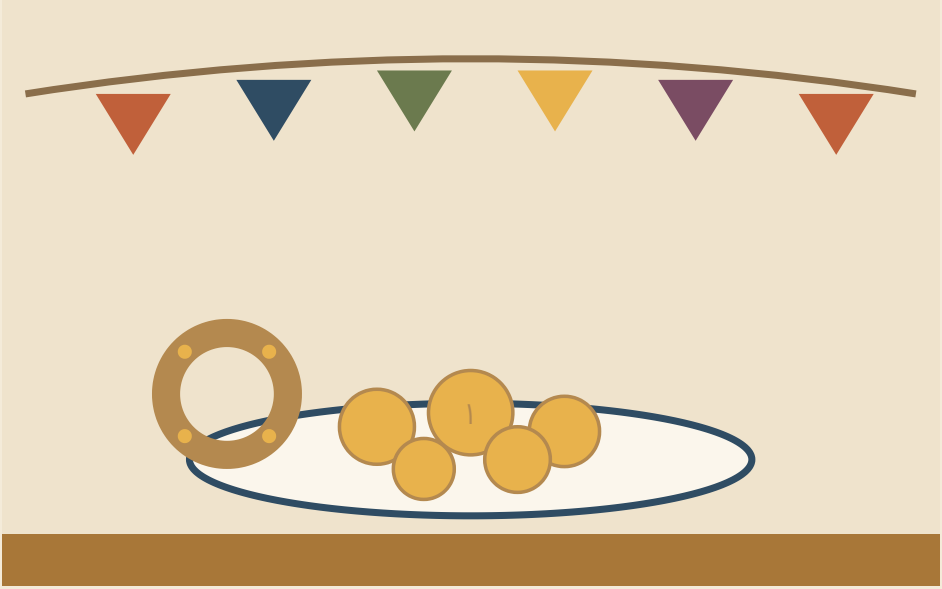
العيد

il-3eed

Eid



Before you start

Eid morning at Sami's — new clothes, house-to-house visits, and عيدية. This book adds "if": the realistic إذا and the wishful لو, plus your first proper look at broken plurals.

THE CHAT ALPHABET

7	ح	hard breathy H
5	خ	kh
3	ع	ayn
2	ء	glottal stop *only* — hamza
8	غ	French-style r
q	ق	written q, said as a glottal stop in Jerusalem

EID WORDS YOU'LL WANT FAST

كل عام وانتو بخير	*kill 3aam w-into bi-5eer*	the Eid greeting, to more than one person
بألف خير	*bi-alf 5eer*	the standard reply
عيدية	*3eediyye*	money given to kids at Eid
ضيوف	*dyouf*	guests · sg. ضيف deef

New grammar, in one line. إذا for an "if" that could really happen, لو for one that's just wishful thinking. Both are usually followed by a verb in the past-tense *form* — even when nothing has actually happened yet.



الصبح بدري، فاق سامي قبل الكل وصرخ:

«تيتا! وين قميصي الجديد؟»

تيتا ضحكت من جوا المطبخ وقالت: «هناك، فوق الكرسي، يلا البسه بسرعة قبل ما يجوا الضيوف!»

سامي لبس القميص وقال:

«إذا لبست بسرعة، بدي روح أبارك عند عمي قبل الكل!»

---

is-sob7 badri, faaq Saami qabel il-kill w-sara5:
"Teta! ween qamiisi ij-jdiid?"
Teta di7ket min juwwa il-matba5 w-2aalat: "hunaak, foq il-kirsi, yalla ilbaso bi-sur3a qabel ma yiju id-dyouf!"
Saami libis il-qamiis w-2aal:
"iza libist bi-sur3a, biddi rou7 abaarik 3ind 3ammi qabel il-kill!"

Early in the morning, Sami woke before everyone and shouted: "Grandma! Where's my new shirt?" Grandma laughed from inside the kitchen and said: "There, on the chair, come on put it on quickly before the guests arrive!" Sami put on the shirt and said: "If I get dressed quickly, I want to go congratulate Uncle's family before everyone else!"



طلعوا كلهم عالشارع، وكل بيت كانوا يدقوا بابه ويقولوا:

«كل عام وانتو بخير!»

أهل البيت كانوا يردوا: «وانتو بألف خير! تفضلوا فطروا معنا.»

سامي كان يحب هالعادة كتير، لأنه بكل بيت في حلويات وناس مبسوطة.

---

tal3u killhom 3ash-shaare3, w-kill beet kaanu yduqqu baabo w-2oulu:
“kill 3aam w-into bi-5eer!”
ahl il-beet kaanu yriddu: “w-into bi-alf 5eer! tfaddalu ftaru ma3na.”
Saami kaan y7ibb hal-3aade kteer, la2anno bikill beet fii 7alaweeyaat w-naas mabsouta.

They all went out onto the street, and at every house they'd knock on the door and say: "Every year and you're well!" The people of the house would reply: "And you a thousand times well! Come in, have breakfast with us." Sami loved this custom a lot, because at every house there were sweets and happy people.



عند بيت العم، البنات والولاد كلهم لفوا حوالين الكبار.

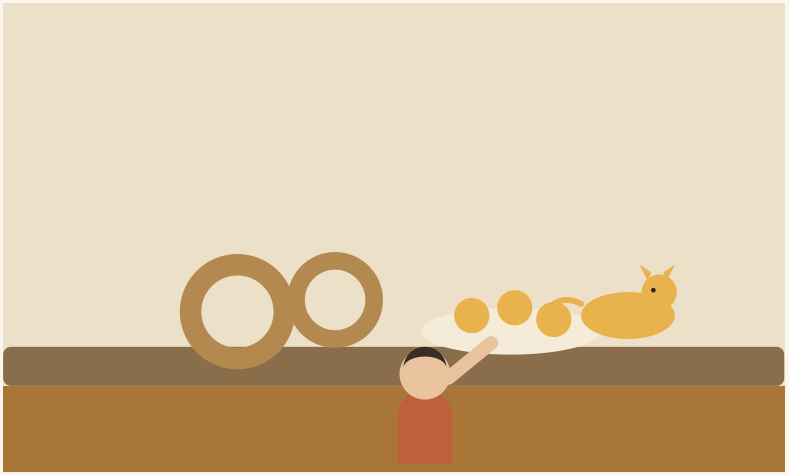
عمو مد ايده وعطى كل ولد وبنت عيدية، وقال: «كل عام وانتو طيبين يا حبايبي!»

سامي عد فلوسه بسرعة وقال لابن عمه:

«شفت؟ عندي عشر شواقل أكتر منك!»

3ind beet il-3am, il-banaat wil-wlaad killhom laffu 7awaleen il-kbaar.
3ammo madd eedo w-3ata kill walad w-bint 3eediyye, w-2aal: "kill 3aam w-into tayybeen ya 7abaaybi!"
Saami 3add flouso bi-sur3a w-2aal la-ibn 3ammo:
"shift? 3indi 3ashar shawaakel aktar minak!"

At Uncle's house, all the girls and boys crowded around the grown-ups. Uncle held out his hand and gave every boy and girl eidiyye money, and said: "Every year and you're well, my dears!" Sami quickly counted his money and said to his cousin: "See? I have ten more shekels than you!"



عالطاولة كان في كعك وأصابع الست ومعمول محشي تمر وجوز.

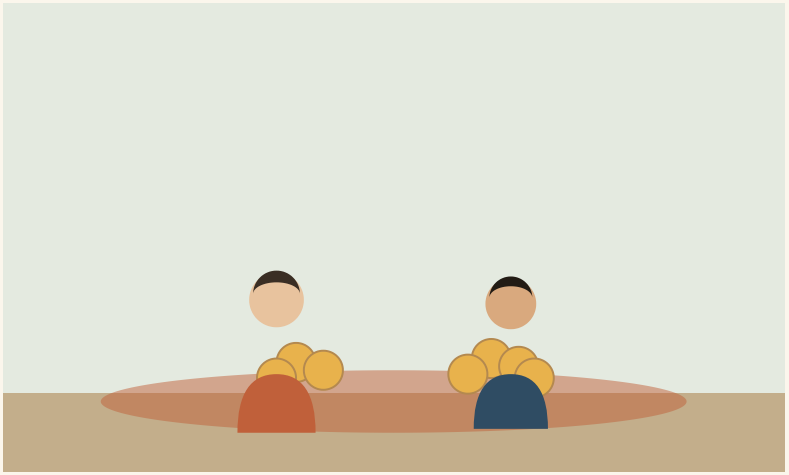
سامي مد ايده ياخد وحدة، وفجأة شاف مشمش قاعدة فوق الطاولة بتاكل قطعة كعك!

صرخ: «مشمش! لأ! هاد مو الك!»

بس مشمش كانت أسرع منه وهربت بالقطعة.

3at-taawle kaan fii ka3ek w-asaabi3 is-sitt w-ma3moul ma7shi tamer w-jooz.
Saami madd eedo yaakhod wa7de, w-faj2atan shaaf Mishmish qaa3de foq it-taawle btaakol qit3et ka3ek!
sara5: "Mishmish! la2! haad muu ilek!"
bass Mishmish kaanet asra3 minno w-hurbet bil-qit3a.

On the table there was ka'ek, "lady's-finger" pastries, and ma'moul stuffed with dates and walnuts. Sami reached out to take one, and suddenly saw Mishmish sitting on the table eating a piece of ka'ek! He shouted: "Mishmish! No! This isn't yours!" But Mishmish was faster than him and ran off with the piece.



بعد ما زاروا كل الأقارب، قعدوا الولاد يعدوا مصاريهم مع بعض.

ابن عمه قال: «أنا جمعت أكتر منك! عندي خمسطعش شيقل زيادة!»

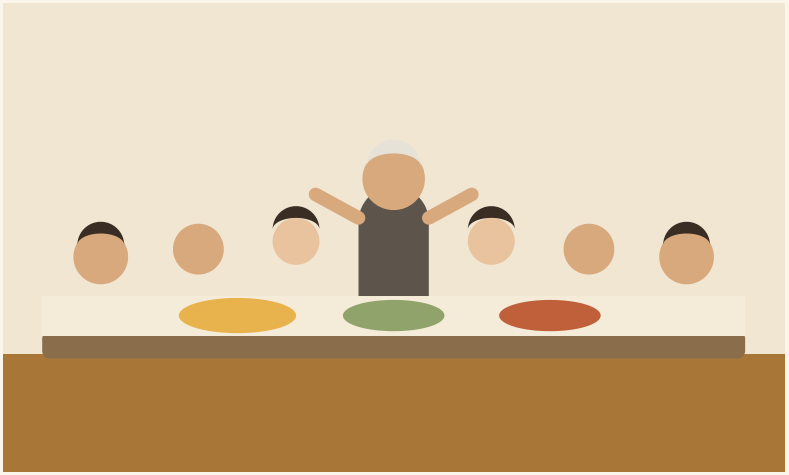
سامي فكر شوي وقال:

«طيب، بس لو جمعنا الاتنين مع بعض، رح يصير عنا مصاري كتير لنشتري لعبة كبيرة!»

---

ba3d ma zaaru kill il-aqaarib, 23adu il-wlaad yi3iddu masaarihom ma3 ba3d.
ibn 3ammo 2aal: "ana jama3t aktar minak! 3indi 5amastaa3ash shiqel ziyaade!"
Saami fakkar shwayy w-2aal:
"tayyib, bass law jama3na il-itneen ma3 ba3d, ra7 yiseer 3anna masaari kteer la-nishtiri li3be kbiire!"

After they'd visited all the relatives, the kids sat down to count their money together. His cousin said: "I collected more than you! I have fifteen shekels extra!" Sami thought for a moment and said: "Okay, but if the two of us put ours together, we'll have a lot of money to buy a big toy!"



عالغدا، اجتمعوا كل الأعمام والخالات والأصحاب حوالين طاولة طويلة.

كل واحد جاب شي: صحن منسف، وصحن سلطة، وصحن حلى.

سيدو رفع صوته وقال: «هلا وسهلا فيكم كلكم، الحمدلله ع السلامة والعيد!»

3al-8ada, ijtama3u kill il-a3maam wil-5aalaat wil-ashaab 7awaleen taawle tawiile.
kill waa7ed jaab shi: sa7en mansaf, w-sa7en salata, w-sa7en 7ala.
Seedo rafa3 sowto w-2aal: "hala w-sahla feekom killkom, il-7amdilla 3as-salaame wil-3eed!"

At lunch, all the uncles, aunts, and friends gathered around a long table. Everyone brought something: a plate of mansaf, a plate of salad, a plate of dessert. Grandpa raised his voice and said: "Welcome, all of you — thank God for your safety and happy Eid!"



بالليل، قعد سامي يعد كل مصاريه، وكانت كتير.

فكر وقال لتيتا: «تيتا، إذا وفرت هالمصاري، بقدر أشتريلك هدية بالعيد الجاي، مش هيك؟»

تيتا حضنته وقالت: «يا روحي، إنت الهدية. بس إذا بدك تفرحني، خليك دايما قلبك طيب متلما انت هلق.»

---

bil-leel, 23ad Saami yi3idd kill masaaryo, w-kaanet kteer.
fakkar w-2aal la-Teta: "Teta, iza waffart hal-masaari, baqdar ashtriilek hdiyye bil-3eed ij-jaay, mish heek?"
Teta 7adnato w-2aalat: "ya rou7i, inte il-hdiyye. bass iza biddak tfar7ini, 5alleek daayman qalbak tayyeb mitlma inte hala2."

At night, Sami sat counting all his money, and it was a lot. He thought and said to Grandma: "Grandma, if I save this money, I could buy you a gift next Eid, right?" Grandma hugged him and said: "My darling, you are the gift. But if you want to make me happy, always keep your heart as kind as it is now."

Words from this story

Eid morning, greetings, and eidiyye.

فاق	*faaq*	he woke up · يفوق yfuuq to wake up
قميص	*qamiis*	shirt
عادة	*3aade*	a custom, a habit
بألف خير	*bi-alf 5eer*	"a thousand times well" — the reply to the Eid greeting
مد ايده	*madd eedo*	he held out his hand
عيدية	*3eediyye*	money given to kids at Eid
عد	*3add*	he counted · يعد yi3idd to count
شيقل	*shiqel*	shekel · pl. شواقل shawaakel
محشي	*ma7shi*	stuffed (with something)
هرب	*hirib*	he/she ran off, fled

Words from this story · continued

أقارب	*aqaarib*	relatives
وفر	*waffar*	he saved (money) · يوفر ywaffir
منسف	*mansaf*	the rice-and-lamb dish, guest of honour food
رفع صوته	*rafa3 sowto*	he raised his voice
الحمدلله عالسلامة	*il-7amdilla 3as-salaame*	"thank God for your safety" — welcoming someone back
حضن	*7adan*	he/she hugged · يحضن y7adin
فرح	*farra7*	to make (someone) happy · تفرحني tfar7ini you make me happy
قلب طيب	*qalb tayyeb*	a kind heart
جاي	*jaay*	coming, next · العيد الجاي next Eid

Dialect notes

Two kinds of "if", and plurals that don't follow a formula.

1 · إذا vs لو

إذا is for an "if" that could really happen:
إذا وفرت المصاري، بقدر أشتريلك هدية. *iza waffart il-masaari, baqdar ashtriilek hdiyye.* If I save the money, I can buy you a gift.

لو is for wishful or unreal "if":
لو جمعنا الاتنين، رح يصير عنا مصاري كتير. *law jama3na il-itneen, ra7 yiseer 3anna masaari kteer.* If we pooled the two together, we'd have a lot of money.

Notice both are followed by a verb in the *past-tense form*, even though nothing has happened yet — that's just how the sentence is built. Don't read it as an actual past.

2 · PLURALS — SOUND AND BROKEN

Some plurals just add an ending (sound plurals). Most don't — the word for "many" reshapes itself (broken plurals), and there's no shortcut: you learn each one by ear.

ولد ← ولاد	*walad ← wlaad*	boy(s) — broken
بنت ← بنات	*bint ← banaat*	girl(s) — sound
عم ← أعمام	*3am ← a3maam*	uncle(s) — broken
خالة ← خالات	*5aale ← 5aalaat*	aunt(s) — sound
صاحب ← أصحاب	*saa7ib ← ashaab*	friend(s) — broken
ضيف ← ضيوف	*deef ← dyouf*	guest(s) — broken
بيت ← بيوت	*beet ← byout*	house(s) — broken

Dialect notes · continued

3 · "MORE THAN" WITH A NUMBER

Drop the number straight in before أكتر من — no extra grammar needed:
عندي عشر شواقل أكتر منك. *3indi 3ashar shawaakel aktar minak.* I have ten shekels more than you.

4 · THE EID EXCHANGE

THEY SAY		
كل عام وانتو بخير	*kill 3aam w-into bi-5eer*	said first, to a group
بألف خير	*bi-alf 5eer*	the reply
الحمدلله عالسلامة	*il-7amdilla 3as-salaame*	welcoming someone home

Where to go next. Try building three sentences of your own with إذا about things that could really happen this week, and one with لو about something that definitely won't.

Now you try

Pick إذا or لو carefully — one of these is real, one is a daydream.

1 · FILL THE GAP

١. زرتنا بكرة، بدنا نعملك قهوة ___ *(a real possibility)*

٢. كان عندي طيارة، كنت طرت عالقمر ___ *(pure daydream)*

٣. جمعنا فلوسنا، بنقدر نشتري لعبة ___ *(a real possibility)*

2 · GIVE THE PLURAL

عم ← _____ بنت ← _____ ضيف ← _____

3 · TRANSLATE INTO DIALECT

١) "Every year and you're well!"

٢) I have five shekels more than you.

٣) If you save your money, you can buy something nice.

Answers. 1) 3 — أعمام · بنات · ضيوف 2) — إذا · لو · إذا) عندي خمس · كل عام وانتو بخير!
إذا وفرت مصاريك، بتقدر تشتري شي حلو. · شواقل أكتر منك.